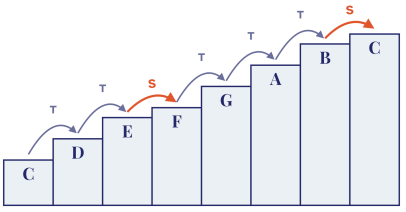
SCALES AND KEYS · SCALES · LEARN

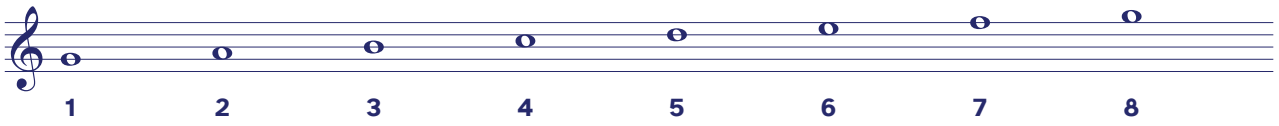
Scales and keys



REMEMBER Every major scale has the same pattern: T T S T T T S.

1 Fix the scale ★★☆

This should be G major, but one note is missing its sharp. Add it, then answer.



the note that needs a sharp ☐ semitones between degrees ☐ – ☐ and ☐ – ☐

2 The major pattern ★☆☆

Write T or S between each pair of degrees.

1 T 2 T 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐ 7 ☐ 8

3 Degree names ★☆☆

Write the name of each degree.

DEGREE	NAME	DEGREE	NAME
1	tonic	2	
5		3	
4		6	
7			

4 Relative minor ★★☆

Each major key shares its key signature with a minor key. To find it, go down a minor 3rd: count 2 keys between, then land.

C major → **A** minor

G major → ☐ minor

F major → ☐ minor

D major → ☐ minor

B♭ major → ☐ minor

E♭ major → ☐ minor

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · MINOR SCALES · LEARN

Minor scales

REMEMBER Natural minor: the major on the same note with 3, 6 and 7 one key lower. Harmonic minor: raise the 7th again.

1 Which notes move?

★☆☆

From C major to C natural minor, three degrees move one key lower. Write their numbers.

☐ ☐ ☐

2 Build it

★★☆

Write the notes of each scale, going up. The first is done.

SCALE	NOTES
C natural minor	**C D E♭ F G A♭ B♭ C**
D natural minor	
A harmonic minor	
D harmonic minor	
E natural minor	

3 Melodic minor

★★☆

Write A melodic minor going up, then coming down.

	NOTES
going up	
coming down	

4 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

C natural minor starts on the same note as C major.	T F
The harmonic minor raises the 6th.	T F
Coming down, the melodic minor is the natural minor.	T F

5 Play it

★☆☆

Play C major, then C natural minor, then C harmonic minor. Bright, dark, then leaning home. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · SCALES · USE

Scales and keys

REMEMBER The order of sharps: F C G D A E B. The order of flats is the same, backwards.

1 Name the key

★★☆

Write the major key and its relative minor for each key signature. The first is done.



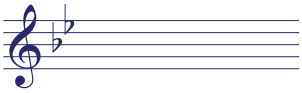
major G minor _____



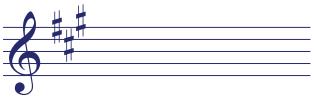
major _____ minor _____



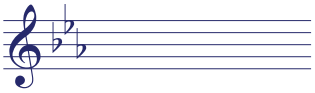
major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____

2 Which minor?

★★★

Three forms of A minor, going up. Write natural, harmonic or melodic under each.

A



_____

B



_____

C



_____

3 In order

★☆☆

Write the order of sharps and the order of flats.

Sharps							
Flats							

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play each scale one octave, hands separately. Tick a circle each day it is even and correct.

G major ○ ○ ○ ○ **F major** ○ ○ ○ ○ **A harmonic minor** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · FINDING THE KEY · USE

Finding the key

REMEMBER Sharps: the last sharp, then the very next key up. Flats: the second-last flat (one flat: F major). Then look for the clue note and the last note.

1 Name the major key

★★☆

Write the major key for each key signature. The first is done.

2 sharps → **D**

3 sharps → ☐

4 sharps → ☐

1 flat → ☐

2 flats → ☐

3 flats → ☐

2 Major or minor?

★★★

The key signature gives two suspects. The clue note (a raised 7th) and the last note name the key. The first is done.

KEY SIGNATURE	CLUE NOTE	LAST NOTE	KEY
1 sharp	D♯	E	**E minor**
none	G♯	A	
2 flats	F♯	G	
1 flat	none	F	
2 sharps	A♯	B	

3 The detective's steps

★☆☆

Number the steps 1, 2, 3 in the order you check them.

the last bass note ☐

the key signature ☐

the clue notes ☐

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	KEY
the key signature		☐
a clue note (a raised 7th)		☐
the last bass note		☐

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · THE CIRCLE OF FIFTHS · USE

The circle of fifths

REMEMBER Go right round the circle: one more sharp each step. Go left: one more flat.

1 Walk the circle

★★☆

Write the next keys round the circle, and how many sharps or flats each has. The first two are done.

	C	1	2	3	4	5
right	C · 0	G · 1♯				
left	C · 0	F · 1♭				

2 How many?

★★☆

Count the steps from C to find the number of sharps or flats.

A major ☐ sharps

E♭ major ☐ flats

E major ☐ sharps

B♭ major ☐ flats

B major ☐ sharps

A♭ major ☐ flats

3 Neighbours on the clock

★★☆

Write the key.

right of D ☐

left of C ☐

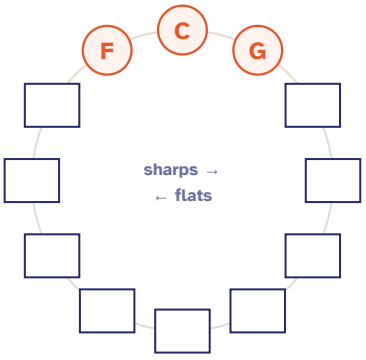
opposite C ☐

inside G (its relative minor) ☐

4 Fill the clock

★★☆

Write the twelve major keys round the clock. C, G and F are done. (At the bottom, one key has two names.)



5 Say it

★☆☆

Say the circle out loud, right and then left, without looking. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____